Cheick Camara

Economist | Ph.D. in Economics

CERDI, Université Clermont Auvergne (UCA-CNRS-IRD)

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Professional Summary

Economist (Ph.D., CERDI-UCA) with five years of applied research at the intersection of fiscal policy, structural reforms and cross-country econometric analysis, developed across the World Bank, the European Commission (JRC) and the Council on Economic Policies. Produces original empirical evidence using causal inference methods (DiD, RDD, 2SLS, GMM), panel data and micro-data analysis, applied across a broad range of policy contexts, from subnational public finance reviews in West Africa to EU cohesion-fund assessment across member states. Research spans fiscal federalism, gender budgeting and political economy. Fluent in translating technical findings into policy briefs for senior officials. Finalist, *Ma Thèse en 180 Secondes*. Fluent French/English (C1); working Spanish.

Professional Experience

Short-Term Consultant *Jan 2026 - Jun 2026*
World Bank Group, Washington DC – EAGW2 Governance Unit

- Built the econometric backbone of a Subnational Public Finance Review and Contributed to strengthen the governance evidence base for Ghana's Country Growth and Jobs Report.
- Co-authored regional reform guidelines addressing weak fiscal transparency in CEMAC state-owned enterprises, adopted into the region's SOE reform agenda.
- Co-built an original cross-country dataset on budgetary classification across Central & West Africa in the absence of comparable data, informing a GovTech budget-transparency initiative.
- Drafted lending and technical-assistance concept notes for five fragile-context countries (Cameroon, CAR, Congo, Eq. Guinea, Gabon) and represented the team in PIMA and DRM missions in Gabon, liaising directly with national government officials and country delegations.

Scientific Trainee *Oct 2025 – Jan 2026*
Joint Research Centre, European Commission, Seville – Territorial Development

- Built automated Python/Stata pipelines harmonizing NUTS-2 data to give cohesion-policy teams a systematic way to benchmark EU-fund efficiency across regions, feeding into the unit's ongoing territorial monitoring and forecasting exercises.
- Authored a reproducible methodological note on European funds data collection, designed for reuse by the unit and disseminated to policy teams across Directorates.

Consultant *Apr 2024 – Dec 2025*
Council on Economic Policies (CEP), Online

- Co-led data collection for the Global Tax Expenditures Transparency Index (GTETI), making tax-expenditure reporting comparable across a fragmented country sample.
- Led final review and drafting of GTETI assessments for Mali and Côte d'Ivoire, ensuring methodological consistency.

Research Assistant – Environmental Taxation *Jun 2022 – Aug 2022*
CERDI, Université Clermont Auvergne

- Commissioned by the French Foreign Ministry to address waste management, congestion and emissions through environmental tax policy in African countries; delivered a policy report with actionable recommendations.

Research Assistant *Apr 2022 – Jun 2022*
FERDI

- Conducted literature review and empirical analysis on the social effects of indirect taxation across African countries, informing FERDI's domestic revenue mobilization agenda.

Research Assistant Intern *Jul 2021 – Oct 2021*
LASAARE, Université Hassan II of Casablanca

- Quantified the impact of tax expenditures on Moroccan households' consumption of cultural goods, supporting targeted tax-policy design.

Economist Intern *Feb 2021 – Jul 2021*
French Treasury – Direction Générale du Trésor

- Drafted macro-financial policy briefs on the banking sector and trade for four Indian Ocean economies.
- Produced FATF-related assessments on money laundering and terrorism financing for Comoros, supporting international standard-setting dialogue.

Education

Ph.D. in Economics *Nov 2021 – May 2026*
CERDI, Université Clermont Auvergne

- Dissertation: *"Assessing local public policies in India: gender budgeting and federalism in focus"* — applied macro/micro-econometric analysis of fiscal policy across 28 Indian states over three decades.
- Advisors: Bertrand Laporte and Emilie Caldeira
- Committee: Martial Foucault, Michael Keen, Francesca Marchetta, Pierre-Guillaume Meon, Grégoire Rota-Graziosi and Anabela Santos.

M.S. in Economics — Public Finance focus *2019 – 2021*
Université Clermont Auvergne

- Thesis: *"Fiscal decentralization and economic growth"*
- Advisors: Bertrand Laporte and Emilie Caldeira

B.S. in Public Policy Analysis *2016 – 2019*
Université Clermont Auvergne

Teaching & Mentoring

Teaching Assistant and Adjunct Lecturer *Jan 2022 – May 2025*
Université Clermont Auvergne

- Designed and delivered microeconomics, macroeconomics and quantitative-methods courses, mentoring students in applying econometric tools to policy questions.

Guest Lecturer *Sept 2023 – Jan 2024*
Wesford Business School

- Taught data analysis, geopolitics and corporate strategy to undergraduate and MBA cohorts.

Working Papers & Publications

Promises on Paper or Money Well Spent? Gender Budgeting Delivers *Job Market Paper – Under Review, Economics of Governance*

Gender Budgeting and Health Spending Efficiency in Indian States *CERDI Working Paper*

Designing Autonomy: Federalism, Conflict, and the Lessons of Fragility *R&R, Journal of Institutional Economics*

Federalism and Women's Empowerment in India

Mobile Money Adoption and Poverty Reduction in African Countries *joint w/ A. Alassani, J. Tinta – 46 countries, 1990–2020*

[WIP] Can we trust subnational government discourse, or is it just ex-post rationalization of what we already know? *Text-as-data, Indian state budget speeches*

Conferences, Skills & Certifications

Conferences: EUDN Ph.D. Workshop & AFSE Doctoral Days, Paris (2024); LAGV, Marseille & Welfare and Policy Conf., Bordeaux (2023); GDN Conf., Clermont-Ferrand & FERDI/MRIP Webinar (2022).

Programming & Software: Python, R, Stata, EViews, GAMS (Intermediate), Julia (Intermediate), LaTeX.
Econometric Methods: Causal inference (DiD, RDD, 2SLS), macro-econometrics, forecasting, time series, panel data analysis.
Languages: French (Native), English (C1/Fluent), Spanish (B1).
Certifications: IMF Financial Programming & Policies: Macroeconomics Account; IMF Public Financial Management.
Scientific Communication: Finalist, *"Ma Thèse en 180 Secondes"* (MT180).
Reviewer: *Public Choice.*

References

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